

One answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties, **and**

phenomenal properties can
cause physical properties.

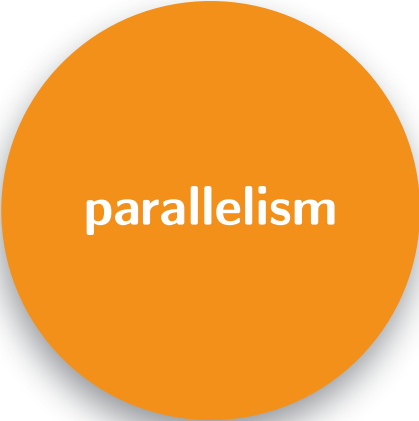
A second answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties; **but** phenomenal
properties cannot cause
physical properties.

A third answer is: No.
Physical and phenomenal
properties cannot causally
interact.



interactionism

A large, solid orange circle is centered on a white background. The word "parallelism" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters across the middle of the circle.

parallelism



**epi-
phenomenalism**

Each of these views has its own strengths and weaknesses.

ANN'S BLOOD SUGAR
FALLS BELOW 80
MG/DL

ANN FEELS HUNGER,
AND DECIDES TO
WALK TO THE
FRIDGE.

ANN WALKS TO THE
FRIDGE AND OPENS
THE DOOR

ANN HAS A VISUAL
SENSATION OF AN
APPLE AND DECIDES TO
EAT IT.

ANN REACHES OUT FOR THE
APPLE AND BRINGS IT TO
HER MOUTH AND TAKES A
BITE.

ANN TASTES THE APPLE
AND FEELS LESS
HUNGRY .





Let's start with the parallelist. This looks like the craziest of the
three views -- why would anyone hold it?





One reason for taking parallelism seriously is that causal connections between the physical and mental realms can look very puzzling.

There are two main lines of argument against the parallelist. This first is simple. It posits a massive coincidence between the physical and mental realms. On this view, mental events reliably correspond to physical events, but there are no causal connections at all between them. What could explain this?

For this reason, virtually all defenders of parallelism have been theists, who hold that God arranged the world so that there was a harmony between the physical and mental orders. But some have wondered whether God wasn't thereby creating an illusion of causal connection between the mental and physical.

phenomenal properties can

Physical properties can

causaphenomenal

One answer is: Yes.

causal/physical properties.

properties, and

A second answer is: Yes.

physical properties.

Physical properties can

causal phenomena

properties; but phenomena

properties cannot cause



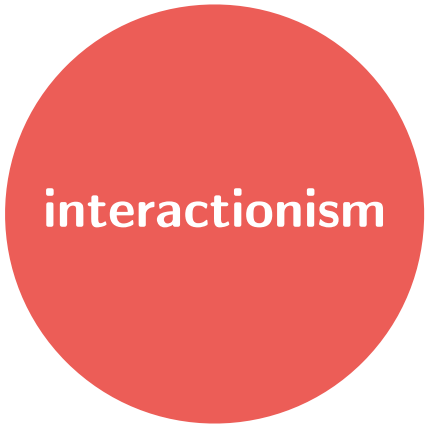
A third answer is: No.

Physical and phenomenal

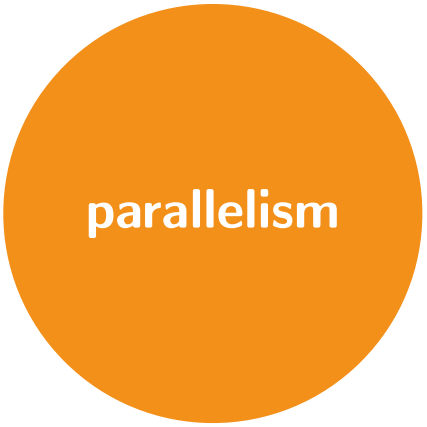
properties cannot causally



interact.



interactionism

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parallelism

epi-

phenomenalism

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